

BOOK FOURTH.

PSALM XC.

1 ¶ A PRAYER of MOSES the man of God. Lord, a place of refuge^a hast thou been unto us in all generations.

2 Before yet the mountains were brought forth, or thou hadst ever produced the earth and the world, even from everlasting to everlasting, thou art God.

3 Thou turnest man to contrition,^b and sayest, Return ye children of men.

4 For a thousand years are in thy eyes but as the yesterday when it is past, and as a watch in the night.

5 Thou carriest them away as with a flood; they are as a sleep: in the morning^c (they grow) like the grass which changeth.

6 In the morning it blossometh, and is changed: in the evening it is mowed off, and withereth.

7 For (thus) are we consumed by thy anger, and by thy fury are we terrified.^d

8 Thou hast set our iniquities before thee, our concealed sins before the light of thy countenance.

9 For all our days are passed away in thy wrath: we consume our years like a word that is spoken.^e

10 The days of our years in this life^f are seventy years; and if by uncommon vigour they be eighty, yet is their greatness^g trouble

and mishap; for it soon hasteneth off, and we fly away.

11 Who knoweth the strength of thy anger, and thy wrath which is like the fear of thee?

12 Let us then know how to number our days, that we may obtain a heart endowed with wisdom.

13 Return, O LORD, how long yet?^h and bethink thee concerning thy servants.

14 Oh satisfy us in the morning with thy kindness, that we may be glad and rejoice throughout all our days.

15 Cause us to rejoice as many days as those wherein thou hast afflicted us, the years wherein we have seen unhappiness.

16 Let thy act be visible on thy servants, and thy majesty over their children.

17 And may the beautyⁱ of the LORD our God be upon us; and the work of our hands do thou firmly establish upon us: yea, the work of our hands—firmly establish thou it.

PSALM XCI.

1 ¶ He^k who sitteth under the secret protection of the Most High, shall rest under the shadow of the Almighty.

2 I will say of the LORD, who is my refuge and my stronghold, my God, in whom I ever trust,

3 That he will surely deliver thee from

^a Rashi. Lit. "dwelling," or "place of abiding" against danger; hence, "refuge."

^b Rashi and Joseph Kimchi, who conceive that sufferings brought on man are the means alluded to, to effect this contrition; they are followed by Mendelssohn and Sachs. רָגַע stand for "contrite," in Isaiah lvii. 15. But Aben Ezra, "Thou bringest man back (in his old age) to dissolution, and sayest, Return ye (to the dust), O children of men;" and so translate Philippon and Herzheimer.

^c Rashi and Aben Ezra, חָרַף "to change." Sachs and others, "In the morning he groweth up like grass—in the morning he blossometh and groweth up," &c. Redak, חָרַף in ver. 6, "he is renovated," as though it were in the *Hiphil* from חָרַף, which has this meaning. Philippon insists that this is the right sense, or rather, "growing constantly larger," and then "in the evening it is cut off," &c. But the Psalmist seems to say, that no sooner has man produced his flower, reached his best, than he changes like the grass; he remains but a moment in his glory; and even speedily following, he is then mowed down and left to wither.

^d Sachs, "we decay." (See Isaiah lxxv. 23.)

^e Rashi. Philippon, "sigh;" (Isaiah xvi. 7; Jer. xlviii. 31; Ezek. ii. 10.) Mendelssohn, "idle talk." Herzheimer, "thought."

^f Jonathan. Rashi refers בָּרַע to "our iniquities;" thus, "through these sins are the days, &c. but seventy years." Sachs, "the years of our life—yea, these are seventy years."

^g Rashi. Aben Ezra, "strength," or "youth," "for it is soon cut off." Mendelssohn, "pride." Philippon, "storm," i. e. the uneasy, stormy, excited state of existence; but I know not whence this meaning is derived. The word רֹחַב (*Rohab*) is found but here; hence the uncertainty of its derivation, and commentators therefore expound as they believe the context warrants. The same is the case with other words of the kind.

^h i. e. Shall the punishment or evil endure?

ⁱ Sachs, "grace." Mendelssohn, "kindliness." Philippon, "favour," or "lovingness."

^k Philippon, "He who sitteth under the protection of the Most High, lodgeth under the Almighty's shadow: I say unto the LORD, My refuge, &c.—for he, he will deliver," &c.

PSALMS XCI.—XCIII.

the snare of the fowler, and from the pestilence of destruction.*

4 With his pinions will he cover thee, and under his wings shalt thou find shelter: shield and buckler is his truth.

5 Thou shalt not be afraid of the terror of the night; nor of the arrow that flieth by day;

6 Nor of the pestilence that stalketh in darkness; nor of the deadly disease that wasteth at noonday.

7 There shall fall at thy side a thousand, and ten thousand at thy right hand; unto thee (however) shall it not come nigh.

8 Only with thy eyes shalt thou behold it, and see the recompense of the wicked.

9 Because thou hast (said),^b The LORD is my protection; the Most High hast thou made thy refuge:

10 No evil shall befall thee, nor shall any plague come nigh unto thy tent.

11 For his angels will he give charge concerning thee, to guard thee on all thy ways.

12 Upon (their) hands shall they bear thee, that thou mayest not dash against a stone thy foot.

13 Upon the fierce lion and asp shalt thou tread: thou shalt trample under foot the young lion and serpent.^c

14 Because he hath fixed his desire upon me, therefore will I release him: I will set him on high, because he knoweth my name.

15 He will call on me, and I will answer him: with him will I be in distress; I will deliver him, and grant him honour.

16 With length of days will I satisfy him, and I will let him see my salvation.

PSALM XCII.

1 ¶ A psalm or song for the sabbath day.

2 It is a good thing to give thanks unto the LORD, and to sing praises unto thy name, O Most High:

3 To tell in the morning of thy kindness, and of thy faithfulness in the nights,

4 Upon a ten-stringed instrument, and

* Philippon renders צָרָה "wickedness;" metaphorical, "the plague of wickedness;" not the actual pestilence which is spoken of in v. 6.

^b Rashi, who supplies "said." Others take these as the words of the Psalmist, "Because thou, O LORD, art my refuge."

^c Elsewhere rendered "dragon," "monster," &c.

upon the psaltery; and with the sweet^d sound of the harp.

5 For thou hast caused me to rejoice, O LORD, through thy doing: because of the works of thy hands will I triumph.

6 How great are thy works, O LORD! exceedingly profound are thy thoughts.

7 A brutish man knoweth it not, and a fool cannot understand this.

8 When the wicked spring up like herbs, and when all the workers of wickedness do flourish: it is that they may be destroyed evermore.

9 But thou art exalted to eternity, O LORD!

10 For, lo, thy enemies, O LORD, for, lo, thy enemies shall perish: all the workers of wickedness shall be scattered.

11 But thou exaltest my horn like that of a reem: I am anointed with fresh oil.

12 And my eye looketh on (the punishment of) those that regard me with envy: of the evildoers that rise up against me my ears shall hear it.

13 The righteous shall spring up like the palm-tree: like a cedar in Lebanon shall he grow high.

14 Planted in the house of the LORD, in the courts of our God shall they spring up.

15 They shall still flourish in high old age; they shall be vigorous and covered with foliage;

16 To declare that the LORD is upright: he is my rock, and there is no faultiness in him.

PSALM XCIII.

1 ¶ The LORD reigneth, he is clothed with excellency; the LORD is clothed, he hath girded himself with strength: (therefore) also the world is firmly established, that it cannot be moved.

2 Firmly established is thy throne from the beginning: from everlasting art thou (God).

3 The rivers have lifted up, O LORD, the rivers have lifted up their voice; the rivers lift up their waves.

^d One opinion cited by Aben Ezra; another referred to by him would make *Higgayon* an instrument, perhaps a guitar. So also Philippon. But if we derive מְדִינָה from מָדָה "to meditate," the meaning would justly be the meditating, soothing, or sweet sound elicited from the strings of the harp. Hence, Mendelssohn, "waked to thinking by the harp."

PSALMS XCIII.—XCV.

4 (But) more than the noise of great waters, than the mighty billows of the sea, is the LORD excellent on high.

5 Thy testimonies are exceedingly steadfast: in thy house abideth holiness,* O LORD! to the utmost length of days.

PSALM XCIV.

1 ¶ O God, of vengeance,^b LORD! O God of vengeance, shine forth.

2 Lift up thyself, O Judge of the earth! bring a recompense upon the proud.

3 How long shall the wicked, O LORD—how long shall the wicked exult?

4 They sputter, they speak hard things: all the workers of wickedness boast themselves.

5 Thy people, O LORD! they crush, and thy heritage they afflict.

6 The widow and the stranger they slay, and the fatherless they murder.

7 And they say, The LORD will not see, and the God of Jacob will not take notice of it.

8 Understand, ye brutish among the people: and ye fools, when will ye become intelligent?

9 He that hath planted the ear, shall he not hear? or he that hath formed the eye, shall he not see?

10 He that admonisheth^c nations, shall he not correct? is it not he that teacheth man knowledge?^d

11 The LORD knoweth the thoughts of man, that they are nought.

12 Happy is the man whom thou admonishest, O LORD, and teachest him out of thy law:

13 That thou mayest grant him repose from the days of evil, until the pit be dug for the wicked.

14 For the LORD will not cast off his people, and his inheritance will he not forsake.

15 For unto righteousness will justice return; and it shall be followed by all the upright in heart.

16 Who will rise up for me against evil-doers? or who will stand forward for me against the workers of wickedness?

17 Unless the LORD had been a help unto me, but a little would have been wanting that my soul had dwelt in the silence of death.

18 When I said, My foot hath slipped: thy kindness, O LORD, sustained me.

19 In the multitude of my (painful) thoughts within me, thy consolations delight my soul.

20 Can there be associated with thee the throne of destructive wickedness, which frameth mischief as^e a law?

21 They band themselves together against the soul of the righteous, and innocent blood do they condemn.

22 But the LORD is become my defence, and my God, the rock of my refuge.

23 And he will bring back upon them their own injustice, and in their own wickedness will he destroy them: (yea,) he will destroy them—the LORD our God.

PSALM XCV.

1 ¶ Oh come, let us sing unto the LORD: let us shout joyfully to the rock of our salvation.

2 Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving, and shout joyfully unto him with psalms.

3 For a great God is the LORD, and a great King above all gods;

4 In whose hand are the deep places of the earth; and whose are the heights of mountains;

5 Whose is the sea, and who hath made it; and whose hands have formed the dry land.

6 Oh come, let us prostrate ourselves and

* Rashi. Redak, "holiness graceth thy house." Others, "becometh thy house."

^b Vengeance in man may be the result of malevolence, because he is subject to passion, and may punish unjustly; hence we are prohibited (Lev. xix. 18) from taking revenge on those who have injured us; but to the Omnipotent belongs properly the prerogative of vengeance; because retribution is the highest prerogative of justice, and this the more in Him who knows all secrets, and is not liable to forgetfulness, and whose very chastisement is mercy.

^c יָרַע generally means "to chastise;" and so do Aben

Ezra and Redak explain it, as having reference to great national calamities like the flood, &c.; but Jonathan renders, "is it possible that he who gave to his people the law should not chastise them when they are guilty?" and hence Philippon, generally, as in our version, "who warneth."

^d Jonathan, Mendelssohn, and others connect this part of verse 10 with verse 11: "he who teacheth man knowledge—the LORD, knoweth," &c.

^e Rashi. Others, "against the law," i. e. of God. The mischief this confederacy of the ugody do is contrary to the divine commands.

bow down: let us kneel before the LORD our Maker.

7 For he is our God; and we are the people of his pasture, and the flock of his hand: yea, this day, if ye will hearken to his voice.

8 Harden not your heart, as at Meribah, as on the day of the temptation in the wilderness:

9 When your fathers tempted me, proved me, although they had seen my doing.

10 Forty years long did I feel loathing on that generation, and I said, It is a people of an erring heart; and they truly acknowledged not my ways:

11 So that I swore in my wrath, that they should not enter into my rest.

PSALM XCVI.

1 ¶ Oh sing unto the LORD a new song: sing unto the LORD, all the lands.

2 Sing unto the LORD, bless his name: announce from day to day his salvation.

3 Relate among the nations his honour, among all the people his wonders.

4 For the LORD is great, and greatly praised: he is to be feared above all gods.

5 For all the gods of the nations are idols; but the LORD hath made the heavens.

6 Glory and majesty are before him: strength and beauty are in his sanctuary.

7 Ascribe unto the LORD, O ye families of the people, ascribe unto the LORD honour and strength.

8 Ascribe unto the LORD the honour (due unto) his name: bear hither a present, and come unto his courts.

9 Bow down unto the LORD in the beauty of holiness: tremble before him, all ye lands.

10 Say among the nations, "The LORD reigneth;" (therefore) also the world is ever firmly established that it shall not be moved: he will judge the people in equity.

11 Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth be glad: let the sea roar, with all that filleth it.

12 Let the field exult, and all that is therein: then shall all the trees of the forest sing for joy,

13 Before the LORD; for he cometh, for he cometh to judge the earth: he will judge the world with righteousness, and people in his truth.

PSALM XCVII.

1 ¶ The LORD reigneth: let the earth be glad; let the multitude of isles rejoice.

2 Clouds and thick darkness are round about him: righteousness and justice are the support of his throne.

3 A fire goeth before him, and burneth up round about his adversaries.

4 His lightnings give light to the world: the earth seeth it, and trembleth.

5 The mountains melt away like wax at the presence of the LORD, at the presence of the LORD of all the earth.

6 The heavens tell of his righteousness, and all the people see his glory.

7 Made ashamed shall be all that serve graven images, that boast themselves of idols: unto him bow down all the gods.

8 Zion heareth it, and rejoiceth; and glad are the daughters of Judah, because of thy decrees, O LORD.

9 For thou, O LORD, art the most high above all the earth: thou art greatly exalted above all gods.

10 Ye that love the LORD, hate ye the evil: he preserveth the souls of his pious ones; out of the hand of the wicked he ever delivereth them.

11 Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart,

12 Rejoice, ye righteous, in the LORD, and give thanks to his holy memorial.

PSALM XCVIII.

1 ¶ A psalm. Oh sing unto the LORD a new song; for he hath done wonderful things: his right hand and his holy arm have gotten him the victory.

2 The LORD hath made known his salvation: before the eyes of the nations hath he revealed his righteousness.

3 He hath remembered his kindness and his truth toward the house of Israel: all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.

4 Shout joyfully unto the LORD, all the lands: break forth, and rejoice, and sing praises.

5 Sing praises unto the LORD with the harp,—with the harp, and the voice of psalmody.

6 With trumpets and the sound of cornet shout joyfully before the King, the LORD.